

MARKET UPDATE

Monday Edition

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Decentralized Masters

BTC \$86.2K BREAKOUT | +12.5% FROM THU | \$746M SHORTS LIQUIDATED | HYPE NEW ATH \$96 | HORMUZ 6MO HIGH

BRENT \$102 ↓

HYPE NEW ATH \$96→\$93.5

TRUMP-XI WED-THU DC

HORMUZ 6-MO HIGH

SOL \$118 | ETH \$2.75K

WEEK AT A GLANCE

Sep 14 - Sep 21, 2026

BITCOIN (BTC)

\$86,200+

BREAKOUT | +11% from Thu low |
+44% Q3

ETHEREUM (ETH)

\$2,700

\$2,750 | Highest since January 2026 |
ETH leading today

BRENT / WTI

\$101 / \$99

4th straight decline | WTI briefly
sub-\$100

GOLD / S&P FUTURES

\$4,346 /

+0.7%

Gold -0.7%; equities risk-on today

● BTC breaks \$86,200 on its first weekly close above the 50-week MA in 45 weeks

\$746M in futures liquidations, \$647M from shorts. BTC +44% Q3 -- best quarter since Q4 2024. HYPE set new ATH \$96 this morning (now \$93.5). No meaningful friction until ~\$97K.

● Oil falls for 4th straight session -- Iran UNGA talks deflating risk premium

Trump says "probably" open to meeting Iran president at UNGA. Brent \$101.71, WTI briefly below \$100. Direction of travel now lower.

● Trump-Xi summit Thursday -- Bessent met Chinese VP He Lifeng Sunday

Tariff truce framework in discussion. AI safety notification mechanism proposed. S&P futures +0.7%, Nasdaq +1% on risk-on sentiment.

● BTC ETF Friday rescue: \$433M single-day inflow -- largest since Sep 3

Fidelity FBTC \$310.7M, BlackRock IBIT \$108.4M. Week net: \$6.2M positive. ZEC ZCSH ETF: \$37.67M inflows Friday -- strong for a sub-4-week-old fund.

Oil: Four Days Down, Iran Talking at UNGA

BRENT CRUDE TODAY

\$101.71

4th straight decline | Down from \$108.75 Tue

WTI TODAY

~\$99

First time below \$100 since August

FROM PEAK

-6.5%

In 4 trading sessions | Fastest decline since Jun

- Trump said over the weekend he would "probably" be open to meeting Iran president Pezeshkian at UNGA.
- Iran's security chief conveyed conditions to mediators for re-engaging in negotiations. Conditions not published = opening, not agreement.
- Qatar PM urged Gulf states to cooperate. Messages being exchanged between Washington and Tehran.
- Saudi pipeline: partial restoration underway. Hormuz flows hit 6-month high (2.8M bbl/day, vs 700K in August).

Trump-Xi: Xi Arrives DC Wed Evening, Summit Thu

WED
→ THU

Xi arrives DC Wed eve | Summit
Thu Sep 24 in DC

- Treasury Secretary Bessent met Chinese VP He Lifeng for hours Sunday -- pre-summit preparation.
- US proposed AI safety notification mechanism; China described meetings as covering "AI and trade."
- Tariff truce extension framework in discussion. Markets pricing a constructive outcome.
- Xi skipped UNGA to come directly to DC -- the strongest signal that this summit matters.

Also Wed Sep 23: Flash PMIs. Aug showed mfg 53.9, services 56.5. Expansion means Dec hike stays live; any sub-50 reading = major risk-on catalyst.

The \$85K Breakout: Five Catalysts Converging

01

50-Week MA Reclaimed

First weekly close above 50wk MA in 45 weeks at \$78,786. Galaxy Research confirmed close at \$81,159. Historically reliable trend-change signal.

02

\$746M Short Squeeze

\$647M of \$746M in futures liquidations came from shorts. Mechanical buying as positions at \$82K-\$86K were margin-called.

03

Oil Declining

Brent \$108 -> \$101 in 4 days. Lower oil = lower December hike odds = lower discount rate for BTC = higher price.

04

Call Wall at \$85K Cleared

Glassnode identified heavy options call wall at \$85K. When broken upside, delta-hedging by market makers creates additional buying pressure.

05

No Overhead Friction

CoinDesk: limited trading history between \$84K and \$97K. Wide open runway for fast price discovery if momentum holds.

BTC Technical: \$85K Cleared, \$97K Is the Next Real Resistance

\$86,200+

Above every major moving average | Outside upper Bollinger Band |
RSI 71.58 daily

Next Big Target

~\$97K

No meaningful overhead
friction until here

Daily R1

\$86,583

Key daily level -- close
above opens \$97K runway

Hourly R1

\$85,620

Immediate overhead; being
tested now

CURRENT PRICE

\$86,200+

Above all major MAs, all
Bollinger Bands

First Support

\$82,400

Aug high now flipped to
support

50-Week MA

\$78,786

First weekly close above in
45 weeks

JH Floor

\$76,877

Held through every
September test

ETF Flows: From Crisis to Recovery in Five Days



WEEK NET: +\$6.2M | Barely positive, but recovered from -\$746M hole | Fidelity FBTC led Friday at \$310.7M | BlackRock IBIT +\$108.4M

- Friday's \$433M was the largest single-day inflow since Sep 3. Confirmation that institutional buyers re-engaged after CLARITY/FOMC shock.
- ZEC ZCSH Grayscale ETF: \$37.67M in Friday inflows. Strong for a fund under 4 weeks old. Demand thesis for privacy coins intact.
- ETH ETFs: -\$140.6M on the week. BTC/ETH flow divergence is notable -- capital rotating within crypto toward Bitcoin.

ZEC & HYPE: Post-ATH Update in a \$85K World

ZCASH (ZEC)

\$1,500 ↓

Temp breakout \$1,570 → back to \$1,500 | Slightly weak vs BTC/ETH/SOL
| ZCSH ETF \$37.67M

- ZEC briefly broke out to \$1,570 (new 2026 high above prior ATH range) then pulled back to \$1,500.
- Slightly underperforming BTC, ETH, SOL today -- capital concentrated in most liquid assets.
- Holding ABOVE prior ATH zone (\$1,225-\$1,388) -- this is constructive base-building behavior.
- ZCSH ETF \$37.67M Friday inflows; NU7 dev ongoing; Sep 30 deadline for ready features.

HYPERLIQUID (HYPE)

\$93.50

NEW ATH \$96.00 this morning | Now \$93.50 | +7.2% from prior ATH \$89.54

- NEW ATH \$96.00 set this morning -- previous ATH was \$89.54 (Sep 6). ATH confirmed, breakout validated.
- Now at \$93.50 -- healthy consolidation. New resistance: \$96. Path toward \$100+ opens if it holds.
- Protocol: \$4.07B+ burned, \$419M-\$600M annualized revenue, 40-44% onchain perp share.
- Multicoin Capital reducing position -- known overhead seller. Watch \$93 as key support level.

The 2022 Analog: Tracking Ahead of Schedule

2022 PATTERN

- Mar 16, 2022: Fed first hike.
- BTC ~40% below Nov 2021 ATH.
- Next 12 days: BTC +18% to \$47K.
- Then: -50%+ months later (FTX).

2026 NOW -- TRACKING FASTER

- Sep 16, 2026: Fed first hike.
- BTC ~32% below Oct 2025 ATH of \$126K.
- Day 5: BTC already +11% to \$85K (2022 took 12 days for 18%).
- Key question: does month-end hold or reverse?

STRUCTURAL DIFFERENCES IN 2026: \$95B in ETF assets | No FTX-scale leverage | SEC/CFTC commodity framework | Corporate treasury buyers

Scenario A -- STRUCTURAL BREAKOUT

BTC holds \$82K+ at Sep 28-30 close. Analog fails. Path to \$90K-\$97K opens.

Scenario B -- ANALOG TRACKS

Peaks Sep 28-30, rolls over. First support \$78,786 (50-wk MA), then \$76,877 JH floor.

Week Ahead: September 21-26

Mon Sep 21

**UNGA Opens +
Trump-Iran Talks
Possible**

HIGH

Iran diplomacy begins. Any Trump-Pezeshkian meeting = oil falls further; BTC bullish.

Tue Sep 22

**ETF Flow Data for
Today's Session**

CRITICAL

Confirms or denies institutional conviction in \$85K breakout. Positive = path to \$87K.

Wed Sep 23

**Flash PMI Data (9:45
AM ET)**

HIGH

Sub-50 reading on services = December hike odds fall sharply = major risk-on catalyst.

2022 Analog: Sep 28-30 is when the 12-day peak arrives. Month-end weekly close = the definitive test. \$82K hold = structural breakout. Roll = analog tracking.

RISK-ON.